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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark Comparison

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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide

Feeling overwhelmed by endless vacuuming while you’re balancing work, kids, and pets?

Imagine a robot that silently sweeps and mops your floors, freeing up precious hours each week.

In this guide we compare the top 2026 models—iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with Auto-Empty Dock, the dock-less Roomba 115X Combo, Shark AI Ultra, and Shark AV2501S AI Ultra—so you can pick the one that matches your home, habits, and budget.

Read on to see which features deliver real-world convenience and which are worth the investment.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Auto-Empty Convenience vs. AI Boundary Mapping

If you hate stopping to dump a dustbin, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock does the work for you. After each run it returns to its base, empties the bin into a sealed bag, and you only replace the bag every 30-60 days. This hands-off approach means less daily maintenance and more time for family.

By contrast, the Shark AI Ultra and Shark AV2501S AI Ultra focus on smarter navigation. They use AI-driven boundary mapping to avoid obstacles, target high-traffic zones, and adapt their paths in real time—but you still need to empty the bin manually after each cycle.

Vacuuming, Mopping, and Docking Capabilities

Model	Price (Oct 5 2026)	Rating	Auto-Empty Dock	Mopping	Navigation AI	Sales Volume (past month)
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99 (was $469.99)	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	Yes	Yes – vibrating mop pad	Standard sensor suite (no AI mapping)	6K+ bought
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	$139.99 (was $319.99)	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	No	Yes – vibrating mop pad	Standard sensor suite	3K+ bought
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99 (was $599.00)	4.0 (23,990 ratings)	No	No mop	AI boundary mapping & object avoidance	-
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99 (was $429.00)	4.0 (23,990 ratings)	No	No mop	AI boundary mapping & object avoidance	-

Which Navigation System Adapts Better to Irregular Homes?

If your floor plan has tight corners, many furniture legs, or mixed floor types, the Shark models shine. Their AI-powered boundary mapping creates a virtual map, detects obstacles in real time, and adjusts cleaning paths on the fly—reducing missed spots and the need for virtual walls.

The Roomba 115X relies on iRobot’s tried-and-true sensor suite (bump sensors, infrared cliff detection, floor-tracking). It works well in open-plan spaces but may need occasional manual repositioning when it gets stuck.

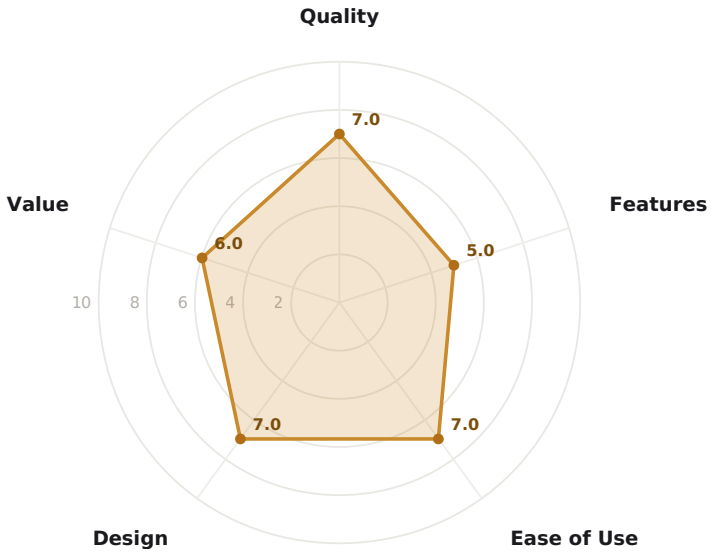
Making Your Decision

Choose the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock if you value set-and-forget bin management and don’t mind a simpler navigation system. Opt for a Shark AI model if you want intelligent obstacle avoidance and are happy to empty the bin yourself. All links above are affiliate links that help support this guide at no extra cost to you.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.